



The Bank of East Asia Improves Its Mobile App Experience with AWS

Learn how The Bank of East Asia, Limited (BEA) delivers a better mobile app experience on AWS, helping accelerate its omnichannel strategy to p

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Overview

As an initiative under its omnichannel strategy, [The Bank of East Asia, Limited](#) (BEA) wanted to enhance the customer experience on its mobile banking app. Recognizing the limitations of on-premises infrastructures, BEA collaborated with Amazon Web Services (AWS) Professional Services to migrate its mobile app on AWS, aiming for better performance and scalability.

By working with AWS, BEA significantly improved its mobile app's performance, enhancing the customer experience. This transformation also helped BEA establish a robust technical architecture while reducing development time, lowering platform costs, and improving app response times.



Opportunity | Revamping the Mobile App Experience

BEA is a financial services group based in Hong Kong and listed on the Hong Kong Stock Exchange. It operates one of the largest branch networks in the city with 48 branches, 42 SupremeGold Centres, and 3 i-Financial Centres.

Building on its extensive branch network, BEA extends its reach through a comprehensive range of internet banking services, anchored by its mobile app, BEA Mobile. Customers use the app to conveniently manage their finances with features such as bill pay, credit card management, and loan applications. As demand for mobile banking rises across its markets, BEA has positioned its mobile app as a core component of its omnichannel strategy, aiming to deliver a seamless banking experience.

To support its strategy, BEA needed to transform the infrastructure behind its mobile app, which was previously hosted on premises in its data center. Growing demand meant that scaling the hardware became increasingly time-consuming and complex—and the infrastructure lacked the flexibility to quickly release new services. Additionally, with financial compliance regulations constantly evolving, BEA's IT team recognized the need for additional

investment to ensure data security and privacy. Stephen Leung, group chief information officer, general manager, and head of technology and productivity division of BEA, explains, “We wanted to migrate BEA Mobile to the cloud to overcome our infrastructure challenges. We were looking for a solution that could boost our agility and provide customers with an enhanced mobile banking experience.”

Solution | Employing AWS Expertise to Accelerate Development

BEA chose to migrate its mobile app to AWS, gaining the scalability to drive development cost-effectively through AWS's pay-as-you-go model. To ensure the migration followed best practices, BEA worked with [AWS Professional Services](#). AWS experts collaborated with BEA to design an enterprise-grade, scalable, and cost-effective architecture leveraging AWS cloud-native services. The solution included an AWS microservices-based infrastructure built on [Amazon Elastic Kubernetes Service](#) (Amazon EKS). Based on AWS recommendations, BEA also implemented [Amazon Relational Database Service](#) (Amazon RDS) for MySQL to simplify the management of the app's database services and [Amazon OpenSearch Service](#) for real-time search, monitoring, and analysis of app data.

Through the [AWS Cloud Adoption Framework](#) (AWS CAF), AWS Professional Services worked with BEA's partners, including IBM, on app development, infrastructure, operations, and security. Part of this process involved developing reusable blueprints that defined cloud standards and future-state operating models. To build its expertise further, BEA established a structured training program that incorporates professional certifications and practical workshops. This initiative aims to equip employees with essential cloud management skills, ultimately enhancing operational efficiency.

By working with AWS Professional Services, BEA reduced the development time for its app, completing the project in 18 months. Additionally, by adopting a pay-as-you-go model on AWS, the bank achieved infrastructure savings compared to its legacy on-premises solution. In terms of performance, app response times improved, enhancing the user experience, while the IT team reduced management time, allowing them to focus on future app developments. Comments Leung, “We’ve created a reliable and robust technical infrastructure on AWS to handle fluctuating user traffic and data streams dynamically in a cost-effective manner.”

Outcome | Supporting Year-on-Year Mobile Transaction Growth with AWS

By developing on AWS, BEA has brought a new level of customer service to its BEA Mobile app. The bank now delivers app updates in a timely manner, ensuring customers have quick access to the latest features and enhancements. Additionally, integrating the app's data with the bank's data lake and implementing data tagging provides BEA with deeper insights into customers' digital footprints. "With the interoperability of our AWS infrastructure, we analyze data in-depth to deliver highly personalized, customer-oriented content and services based on comprehensive user profiles," explains Leung.

With the support of the security framework and third-party solutions from AWS, BEA continues to comply with Hong Kong banking regulations and global financial industry standards. "Combining AWS's security with our security control measures ensured that we maintain compliance in an evolving regulatory landscape," says Leung. Customers have responded positively to the revamped app. This feedback confirms that BEA's goal of providing seamless omnichannel banking is being met. Leung states, "We'll explore with AWS the opportunities to develop cloud solutions that maintain compliance and deliver better customer experiences."

About The Bank of East Asia, Limited

Incorporated in Hong Kong in 1918, The Bank of East Asia, Limited provides a comprehensive range of personal, corporate and private banking, wealth management, and investment services. The bank has operations across Greater China as well as Taiwan, the UK, and the US.

AWS Services Used

AWS Professional Services

Adopting the AWS Cloud can provide you with sustainable business advantages. Supplementing your team with specialized skills and experience can help you achieve those results.

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Amazon Elastic Kubernetes Service

Amazon Elastic Kubernetes Service (Amazon EKS) is a fully managed Kubernetes service that enables you to run Kubernetes seamlessly in both AWS Cloud and on-premises data centers.

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Amazon Relational Database Service for MySQL

[MySQL](#) is the world's most popular [open source](#) relational database and Amazon RDS makes it easy to set up, operate, and scale MySQL deployments in [the cloud](#). With Amazon RDS, you can deploy scalable



MySQL servers in minutes with cost-efficient and resizable hardware capacity.

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Amazon OpenSearch Service

Amazon OpenSearch Service securely unlocks real-time search, monitoring, and analysis of business and operational data for use cases like application monitoring, log analytics, observability, and website search.

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